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# VERBAL ANALOGIES

An analogy compares two things, identifying an important way or ways the two are alike. The type of analogy in this test presents four items arranged in two pairs. For example:

HAND is to ARM as FOOT is to LEG

HAND and ARM is the first pair. FOOT and LEG is the second pair. The two items in Pair 1 have the same relationship that the two items in Pair 2 have. In this case, it is a part-to-whole relationship: a HAND is part of an ARM, just as a FOOT is part of a LEG.

There are twenty-five items on this analogy test. Each is multiple-choice and has five answer choices labeled (A), (B), (C), (D), and (E). The first section is structured so that only one word needs to be filled in:

**1.** NOMENCLATURE is to TERMINOLOGY as RACONTEUR is to

**(A)** NARRATIVE

**(B)** AUDIENCE

**(C)** STORYTELLER

**(D)** JARGON

**(E)** COMMUNICATION

The last section is structured so that a pair of words is needed:

**2.** NOMENCLATURE is to TERMINOLOGY as

**(A)** DEFERENCE is to DISRESPECT

**(B)** DOUBTER is to BELIEVER

**(C)** LASSITUDE is to LIVELINESS

**(D)** GUILE is to FRANKNESS

**(E)** RACONTEUR is to STORYTELLER

Answer: Each pair of words has the same meaning. NOMENCLATURE and TERMINOLOGY both describe a system for naming things; both a RACONTEUR and a STORYTELLER are persons who are skillful at telling stories.

# Types of Analogies

## Synonyms and Antonyms

**Synonyms** are words with identical or similar meanings. For example, *identical* and *alike* are synonyms. **Antonyms** are words with opposite meanings. For example, *opposite* and *matching* are antonyms.

In a **synonym analogy**, the two words in each pair are synonyms. For example:

CONFUSING is to PERPLEXING as
INTELLIGENT is to BRAINY

*Confusing* and *perplexing* are synonyms (have the same or similar meaning), and *intelligent* and *brainy* are synonyms, too.

In an **antonym analogy**, the two words in each pair are antonyms. For example:

COMPREHENSIBLE is to PERPLEXING as
SENSIBLE is to FOOLISH.

*Comprehensible* and *perplexing* are antonyms (words with opposite meanings), and *sensible* and *foolish* are antonyms, too.

### Examples

**1.** DURABLE is to STURDY as ARID is to
- **(A)** PARCHED
- **(B)** THIRST
- **(C)** GLUTTONY
- **(D)** RESILIENT
- **(E)** FLIMSY

**2.** KEEN is to BLUNT as SACCHARINE is to
- **(A)** SALTY
- **(B)** SAVORY
- **(C)** DINGY
- **(D)** SOUR
- **(E)** SUGARY

## Actions and Functions

In an **ACTION ANALOGY**, each pair contains a noun (person, animal, or thing) and a verb that describes an action that person, animal, or thing commonly performs. For example:

HORSE is to GALLOPS as RUNNER is to SPRINTS.

A HORSE GALLOPS, just as a RUNNER SPRINTS.

In a **FUNCTION ANALOGY**, each pair contains a noun and a verb that describes that person's, animal's, or thing's function (what it is supposed to do). For example:

MICROPHONE is to AMPLIFY as
WHEELBARROW is to TRANSPORT

A MICROPHONE's function is to AMPLIFY sound, just as a WHEELBARROW's function is to TRANSPORT things.

### Examples

**3.** WORM is to SQUIGGLES as MOUSE is to

**(A)** CLUMPS
**(B)** FLUTTERS
**(C)** SKITTERS
**(D)** BOUNCES
**(E)** CLANKS

**4.** SCISSORS are to CUT as TAPE is to

**(A)** STICKY
**(B)** TRANSPARENT
**(C)** DEVICE
**(D)** ATTACH
**(E)** DISPENSER

## Size, Degree, and Amount

The word pair in an analogy can also have a relationship of **SIZE**, **DEGREE**, or **AMOUNT**. Here is an example of a degree analogy that shows increasing intensity:

SAD is to DESPONDENT as HAPPY is to ECSTATIC

Someone who is *extremely* SAD feels DESPONDENT; someone who is *extremely* HAPPY feels ECSTATIC.

The example below also shows a relationship of degree/amount:

WHISPERS is to BELLOWS as DRIPS is to GUSHES

When a man WHISPERS he speaks very softly, and when he BELLOWS he shouts very loudly; when a tap DRIPS, a tiny amount of water comes out, and when a tap GUSHES, a large amount of water comes out.

**HELPFUL HINT**

You can use the tone of the words in an analogy to help fill in the missing parts. For example, SAD and DESPONDENT are both negative words. Because HAPPY is a positive word, the second word in the pair should also be positive.